

INTERNSHIP-1 REPORT • BETELGUESE FOUNDATION

Climate Change & Global Warming

A ground-level study through seven solo community-action drives

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From a distant headline to a lived experience

Climate change used to feel confined to journals and UN summits. That changed as its effects began showing up locally — erratic monsoons, longer heatwaves, shrinking green cover, and waste piling up unmanaged. As a CSE student, I didn't expect my first real brush with the subject to happen outside a lab — but Internship-1 with the Betelguese Foundation turned into exactly that.

I took on seven community-facing tasks — entirely solo — spanning cleanliness, plantation, food and cloth donation, education, elder outreach, and animal welfare. Handling every part myself shaped how deeply the experience landed.

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Community activities, one volunteer

- Two cleanliness drives
- Tree plantation drive
- Food donation drive
- Books & stationery distribution
- Cloth donation drive
- Old age home visit
- Stray animal feeding drive

OBJECTIVES

What the internship set out to do

1

Understand the science

How climate change and global warming actually show up in urban/semi-urban settings.

2

Study community action

How drives like cleanups and plantation push back against environmental degradation.

3

Plan & execute solo

Coordinate all seven activities independently within the internship timeframe.

4

Document rigorously

Log dates, locations, methods and outcomes via Weekly Progress Reports.

5

Engage varied groups

Children, elderly residents, and animals — each touched differently by climate issues.

6

Build practical skills

Planning, communication and self-reliance, working without a team.

Why this topic, why solo

The real scale

Most conversations about climate change happen at a scale that feels far from ordinary life — treaties, policy, corporate targets. But the actual damage, and the actual fixing, both happen locally: a littered park, a filthy riverside, an old age home nobody visits, a hungry stray. As an engineering student trained to think in systems, this internship pushed me the other way — toward individuals and neighbourhoods.

Environment meets welfare

Climate change hits vulnerable groups hardest — children without clean surroundings or supplies, elderly citizens rarely included in the conversation, and animals with no voice at all. Working alone meant every call, every bag carried, every conversation was mine to manage — slower and harder, but it made the experience genuinely mine.

The Betelguese Foundation & how the work was done

Area of Study

The Betelguese Foundation runs small, locally-led drives built on consistent, repeated local action rather than one-off big events. Working solo meant coordinating timing and locations directly with Industry Guide Mr. Sagar Chamarti, and reporting each task through a Weekly Progress Report (WPR).

Locations covered:

- Streets & open plots
- Underserved households
- A local old age home
- A community green space
- A school-adjacent community
- Stray-animal gathering spots

Methodology

- 1 Planning & coordination**
Weekly discussion with the industry guide, then solo logistics.
- 2 Field participation**
Every activity done hands-on, in person — no remote version.
- 3 Informal interaction**
Open conversations with residents, children and elders, noted afterward.
- 4 Documentation**
Photographs plus Weekly Progress Reports logging date, plan and outcome.

TIME FRAME

Four weeks, ground to report

Week 1 1–8 June Orientation with the Foundation, topic finalised, two digital outreach tasks.	Week 2 9–15 June Two cleanliness drives and the tree plantation drive.	Week 3 16–22 June Food donation drive and books & stationery distribution.	Week 4 23–29 June Cloth donation drive, old age home visit, stray animal feeding drive.
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Remaining days before submission went into compiling observations, photographs, and this report.

A checklist that never felt like one

01

Cleanliness Drives

Two sites cleared of plastic, paper & hazardous waste

02

Tree Plantation

Native, climate-appropriate saplings with resident aftercare

03

Food Donation

Packets delivered household-by-household

04

Books & Stationery

Supplies for children, paired with an eco-habits chat

05

Cloth Donation

Gently-used clothing sorted and reused, not discarded

06

Old Age Home Visit

Two hours of conversation on lived environmental change

07

Stray Animal Feeding

Scouted locations, cooked meals, consistent timing

Task 1 — Cleanliness Drives

Two solo drives: a shopkeeper-side dumping ground and a vacant plot that had quietly become an unofficial landfill — old packaging, broken glass, even e-waste.

Worked in sections, keeping hazardous material separate. Within days of a similar cleanup nearby, fresh litter had already piled back up.

Link to climate: unmanaged plastic waste adds to emissions when it degrades or is burned in the open — and clogs drains as rainfall grows more erratic.

Task 2 — Tree Plantation Drive

Sourced native, climate-appropriate saplings over ornamental ones, and planted them alone on a stretch of community land with decent soil and sunlight.

Digging, loosening compacted soil and watering each sapling took real physical effort. A few residents committed to informal aftercare — the real driver of survival rate.

Key lesson: a plantation drive is only as good as what survives after — the planting event itself is the easy, visible part.

Task 3 & 4 — Food Donation, Books & Stationery

Food Donation Drive

Packets delivered household-to-household to daily-wage families hit by an unusually harsh heat spell that had cut into their working hours and income.

Books & Stationery

Supplies handed to children, paired with a short chat on littering, trees and switching off unused lights and fans — a small teaching moment alongside the handout.

The overlap that stood out

Climate change and food insecurity are tied together more tightly than expected: erratic weather affects crop yields and prices, and the economically weaker feel it first. A family worried about its next meal isn't going to prioritise waste segregation, however good the messaging — environmental work can't be separated from basic welfare work.

Task 5, 6 & 7 — Cloth, Old Age Home, Strays

Cloth Donation Drive	Old Age Home Visit	Stray Animal Feeding
Gently-used clothes sorted by size and season, cutting textile waste that otherwise burdens landfills and drives new manufacturing demand.	Two hours of open conversation, not a lecture. Residents recalled milder summers and more predictable monsoons — a long-range view no dataset gave me.	Cooked meals delivered on a consistent schedule at scouted gathering spots, building trust with animals that have no shelter from climate extremes.

What the seven tasks add up to

Working Solo

No team to share physical work, logistics, or the emotional weight of certain conversations. Every delay and awkward moment was mine to handle — building real accountability.

Environmental Pattern

Waste piles back up within days without a habit shift. A plantation event is visible; the aftercare that determines survival is not — and matters far more.

Social Overlap

The same households hit by heat-related income loss had the least access to school supplies or seasonal clothing. Climate stress and economic vulnerability travel together.

Central takeaway: climate change isn't purely environmental — it intersects with income, age, education and even species in ways easy to miss from science or policy alone.

Small, realistic steps that could outlast the internship

- 1 Run cleanliness drives on a recurring, scheduled basis rather than as one-off events.
- 2 Add a simple aftercare tracking system for plantation drives — periodic watering checks.
- 3 Standardise pairing educational distribution drives with short environmental awareness sessions.
- 4 Reframe old age home visits as oral-history sessions capturing residents' long-range observations.
- 5 Maintain an informal roster of regular stray-animal feeding volunteers to avoid gaps in care.

What I actually took away from this

Academic & Professional

Sequencing tasks, sourcing on a limited budget, adjusting when logistics didn't cooperate — a useful counterweight to structured coursework.

Social & Emotional

One-on-one interaction with children, elders and low-income households built empathy — and taught me to help with respect, not performance.

Environmental & Ethical

Waste management, afforestation, reuse, and animal welfare now shape small daily choices I didn't think about before.

Personal Growth

Finishing all seven tasks alone — no teammate to lean on — gave me ownership over every decision, from logistics to this reflection itself.

Climate change doesn't live only in reports and policy rooms.

It shows up in a littered street, an unwatered sapling, a hungry stray, and a quiet afternoon at an old age home — all of which, in a small way, I got the chance to actually do something about.

Thank you

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